PROMISE & PRACTICE · DEEP DIVE · SOURCE ANALYSIS

Three Plans for Peace — A House Divided

Three Visions for the Peace

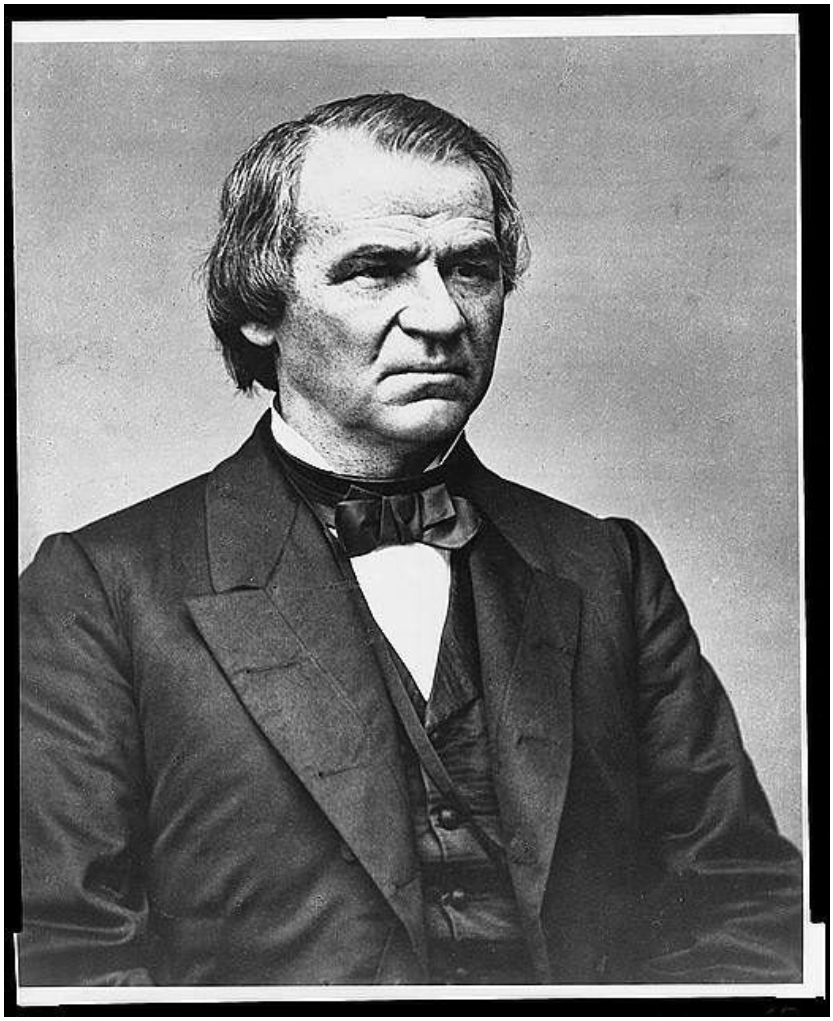
Name: _____ **Period:** _____ **Date:** _____

WHAT I CAN DO TODAY I can read primary sources about Three Plans for Peace — A House Divided, weigh who made each one and why, and use evidence to answer historical questions.

Directions. Lay the plans side by side on the same questions. Comparison reveals what each one really valued

THE SOURCES

THE IMAGE — President Andrew Johnson



Andrew Johnson — photograph, Brady–Handy Collection, public domain (Library of Congress).

SOURCE · COMPARING THE PLANS — Three answers, same questions

Lincoln (10% Plan): quick readmission; pardons for most; little said about freedpeople's rights.
Johnson: generous pardons for ex-Confederates; states rebuilt with few conditions; tolerated Black Codes.
Radical Republicans: protect Black citizenship and voting; bar ex-Confederate leaders; some wanted land for the freedpeople.
— summarized from the historical record. Public domain

— summarized from the historical record. Public domain.

YOUR WORK

QUESTION 1 STEP 1 · SORT THE PLANS

For each plan, answer in a few words: (a) How easy was it for the South to rejoin? (b) How much did it protect freedpeople?

QUESTION 2 STEP 2 · THE SHARPEST DIFFERENCE

What was the biggest difference between Johnson's plan and the Radicals' plan?

- ☐ A. how many states there were
- ☐ B. whether to keep fighting the war
- ☐ C. whether to restore the old Southern order or transform it to protect freedpeople
- ☐ D. who would be the next president

QUESTION 3 STEP 3 · READ STEVENS

Thaddeus Stevens said “the whole fabric of southern society must be changed.” In your own words, what did he mean — and why did he think only that could make America a “true republic”?

QUESTION 4 STEP 4 · YOUR JUDGMENT

Given the goals of securing freedom and reuniting the country, which plan do you think was wisest? Defend your choice in three or four sentences, using the comparison.

TEACHER ANSWER KEY — Three Plans for Peace — A House Divided

QUESTION 1: Open response.

Look for a response along the lines of: "Lincoln: (a)... (b)... | Johnson: (a)... (b)... | Radicals: (a)... (b)..."

QUESTION 2: **Correct — C. whether to restore the old Southern order or transform it to protect freedpeople**

Right. Johnson wanted to restore the old white-run South quickly; the Radicals wanted to transform it and protect the rights of the freedpeople. That gap drove the whole struggle.

QUESTION 3: Open response.

Look for a response along the lines of: "Stevens meant.... He believed this because..."

QUESTION 4: Open response.

Look for a response along the lines of: "I think ___'s plan was wisest because..."